ERA 23

The Post–Cold War World

1991 – 2001

The 1990s · the Gulf War · Clinton · the digital revolution

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How did the end of the Cold War and the rise of the Internet reshape America and the world?

KEY TERMS

The Persian Gulf War · globalization · NAFTA · the digital revolution

ALIGNED TO

CED Topic 9.3–9.4 · AMSCO Ch. 9.3–9.4

AMERICA ALONE AT THE TOP

A New World Order

A New Era

I

The Sole Superpower

With the USSR gone, the U.S. stood unrivaled in power.

II

The Persian Gulf War

A U.S.-led coalition drove Iraq out of Kuwait in 1991—a swift victory.

III

A Wave of Globalization

Trade, technology, and capital flowed across a more connected world.

The Digital Revolution

- The **personal computer** moved from the office into the home.
- By the late 1990s, the **Internet** and **World Wide Web** connected the world.
- A **dot-com boom** transformed business and communication.



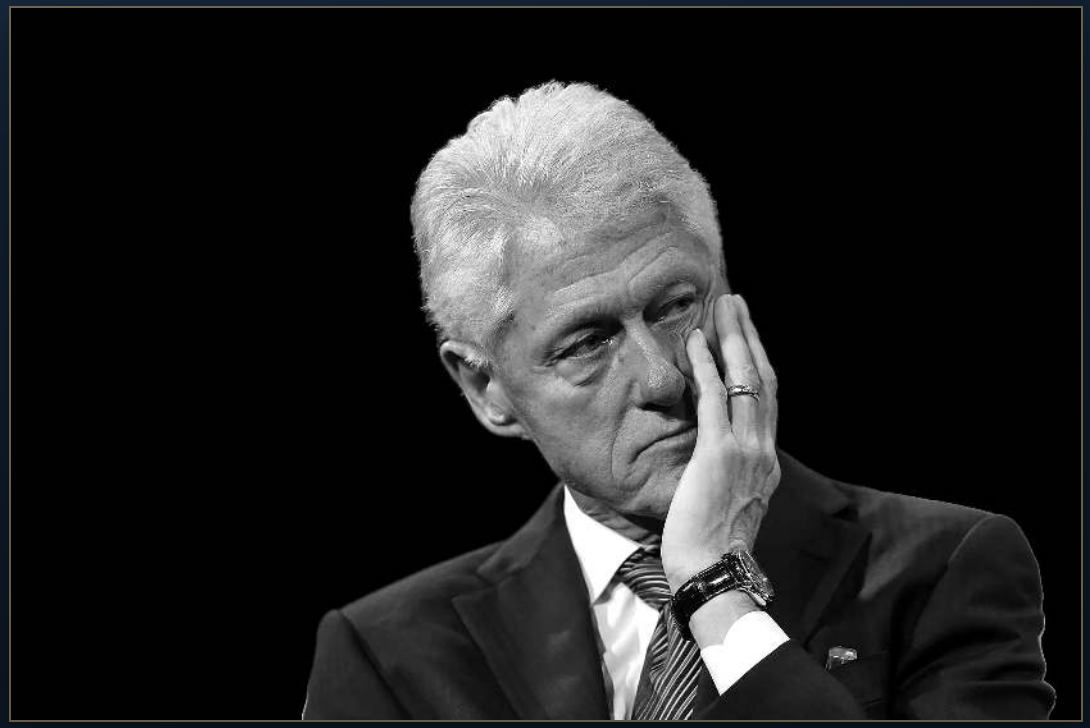
The Internet Economy



- New companies like Amazon and eBay reinvented how Americans shopped.
- Email and the web sped up business and everyday life.
- The U.S. led a new **information economy**.

The Clinton Years

- **Bill Clinton** presided over the longest economic boom in U.S. history.
- He championed **free trade**, signing **NAFTA** in 1994.
- The federal budget swung from deficits to surplus.



Globalization & Its Discontents



- **Free trade** and **outsourcing** sent manufacturing jobs overseas.
- **Deindustrialization** hollowed out the industrial Midwest.
- The boom masked rising **income inequality** and stagnant wages for many.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The Post–Cold War World

1. The end of the Cold War left the U.S. the **sole superpower**, tested in the swift **Persian Gulf War**.
2. The **digital revolution**—the PC and the **Internet**—reshaped the economy and daily life.
3. **Clinton's** boom and **globalization** brought prosperity, but also **outsourcing** and rising **inequality**.

DISCUSS & APPLY

The Post–Cold War World

AP HISTORICAL REASONING PRACTICE

CAUSATION

Explain how the **digital revolution** transformed the American economy and daily life.

COMPARISON

Compare the benefits and costs of **globalization** for different groups of Americans.

CONTINUITY & CHANGE

How did America's role in the world **change** after the Cold War?

Up next — **Lesson 56: The War on Terror** (9/11 & a new era of conflict)